

PG Capstone Units

Dr. Rex di Bona
Faculty of Engineering



We recognise and pay respect to the Elders and communities – past, present, and emerging – of the lands that the University of Sydney's campuses stand on. For thousands of years they have shared and exchanged knowledges across innumerable generations for the benefit of all.



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COMMONWEALTH OF AUSTRALIA

Copyright Regulations 1969

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Agenda

- WHS, Support and Policy from University
- Capstone Unit Overview
- Individual Capstone Unit (5707/08/09)
- Group-based Capstone Unit (5703)
- Q&A session

Staying safe at university

Emergency evacuation

In the unlikely event of an emergency, you may be required to evacuate. All University staff, students and visitors are required to respond to emergency alarms and follow instructions.



Check for any sign of immediate danger



Shutdown equipment/processes that cannot be left unattended



Locate your closest exit



Follow the green exit signs to find your way out of the building (**do not use lifts**)



Proceed to the assembly area, a safe distance from the building, while waiting until the emergency is over.



More information on staying safe in the event of an emergency is available at:
www.sydney.edu.au/about-us/campuses/emergencies-and-personal-safety.html

Emergency evacuation

In some circumstances, we might be asked to remain inside the building for our own safety. We call this a lockdown or shelter-in-place.



You will be notified of an emergency lockdown via **building announcements or other mechanisms** including **verbally by Protective Services**.



It is important that you **follow directions from a warden, Protective Services and/or Emergency Services**, remain calm and **say inside the building**.



More information on staying safe in the event of an emergency is available at:
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Your role in ensuring a safe campus

We are committed to providing a safe and healthy learning environment that is free from bullying, unlawful harassment and discrimination.



You can ensure the safety of yourself and your peers by understanding your rights and responsibilities, which are detailed in our Student Charter.



If you experience or witness any form of behaviour that breaches the Student Charter or our codes of conduct, you can report it to our Student Affairs team.



Our support services, including the Wellbeing team and Safer Communities Office, can support you in dealing with any threats to your safety. You can connect with these teams via the Student Portal.



Accessing tools and support

Accessing tools and support for your studies and wellbeing

Navigate university life with ease using our Student Portal, where you can:



Stay organised with your **Study Dashboard**, which is personalised so that you can view what your semester looks like across all of your units and plan your assignments and to-do lists.



Access University services to help you with your academic and personal wellbeing via the **Services and Support** dashboard. This includes our Wellbeing support teams and our Inclusion and Disability team. This dashboard also has guidance on reporting sexual misconduct, bullying and harassment and seeking support from our Safer Communities Office.



Find new events on the **What's On** page and view all of your classes, registered events and exams in one place using the **Calendar**.



myuni.sydney.edu.au

Accessing assistance at our in-person hubs

Need in person assistance on campus? Visit our campus connect hubs, where we can help you with:

- Completing enrolment
- Understanding your timetable
- Fees and scholarships
- Course planning
- ICT support
- Peer and learning support

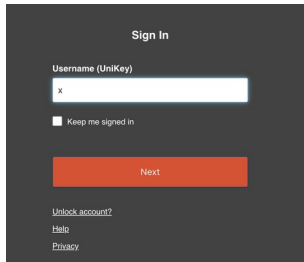
Campus Connect Hubs are open **Monday to Friday, 9 am to 5 pm** in Fisher Library , Susan Wakil Health Building  and the Belinda Hutchinson Building .

You can also collect your Student ID card from our Cards Hub, located in Jane Foss Russell .



Manage access to our University systems

Multifactor Authentication (MFA) is an additional security step to verify your identity at the University.

A screenshot of a dark-themed 'Sign In' form. It features a 'Username (UniKey)' label above a white input field containing the letter 'x'. Below the input field is a checkbox labeled 'Keep me signed in'. A large orange 'Next' button is positioned below the checkbox. At the bottom, there are links for 'Unlock account?', 'Help', and 'Privacy'.

Step 1

*Sign in with your username
(UniKey and password)*



Step 2

*Verify your identity using
your smartphone*



*For more information
Scan the QR code*

Remember:

- Set up a secondary email, phone number and security question in your Okta profile so that you can reset your Unikey.
- Always have your Okta enabled device with you and so not uninstall the Okta verify app.
- If you change your mobile device, install Okta Verify on your new device before removing it from your old one

Special Consideration (University policy)

- If your performance on assessments is affected by illness or misadventure
- Follow proper bureaucratic procedures
 - Have professional practitioner sign special USyd form
 - Submit application for special consideration online, upload scans
 - Note you have only a quite short deadline for applying
 - http://sydney.edu.au/current_students/special_consideration/
- Also, notify coordinator by email *as soon as anything begins to go wrong*
- There is a similar process if you need special arrangements, e.g., for religious observance, military service, representative sports

Academic integrity and the use of AI

Understanding your academic integrity responsibilities

Academic integrity refers to behaving honestly, ethically and responsibly in relation to all elements of your study at the University, including assessments.

It's important that you:



Always submit your own work, sit your own tests, and take your own examinations.



Acknowledge any contributions in your assignment which are not your original thoughts, ideas or words.



Complete the Academic Honesty Education Module (AHM), which all new students must complete by census date.



Listen to your coordinator's instructions on whether digital tools, including grammar checkers and generative AI, are allowed in assessments.



Complete the AHM

Using generative AI

Generative AI tools, such as Microsoft Copilot Chat, can create digital content, including text, images, and video . Different guidelines for use of generative AI apply to learning and assessment:



Generative AI for general learning

- You can use generative AI to help you learn. For example, it can explain things, apply knowledge, plan your study and make practice questions. Use our student co-designed AI resource so you are aware of its strengths and limitations.



Generative AI for assessment

- *Exams and in-semester tests:* you **cannot** use generative AI in supervised exams or in-semester tests, unless your unit coordinator expressly allows it.
- *Other assessments:* you **can** use generative AI, unless your unit coordinator expressly prohibits it.
- Always acknowledge your AI use. Failing to do so, or using AI when not permitted, is an academic integrity breach.
- Each unit will have different rules. Look for the AI icons in the assessment table in your unit outlines to see if AI is allowed.



AI resource made by students:
<https://bit.ly/students-ai>

Which generative AI tools are best to use?

The University provides **free** access to Microsoft Copilot Chat to accelerate your learning and help you complete those assessments where use of generative AI is allowed.



Why use Microsoft Copilot Chat? ✨

- It is a University-supported, industry standard, GPT-4 powered tool
- It keeps your data secure and protects your privacy
- Log in with your UniKey using Okta so that you are using Copilot in protected mode, which introduces necessary guardrails to protect you within the system



Why not use other tools like ChatGPT and DeepSeek?

- Don't risk your privacy or the security of your personal and assessment data by using a free or emerging tool like ChatGPT and DeepSeek



Powerful and secure
<https://copilot.microsoft.com/>

Mandatory Canvas modules

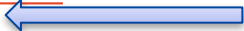
Completing your mandatory Canvas modules

We've developed a series of Canvas modules to help you understand what to expect from the University and what is expected from you. They include:

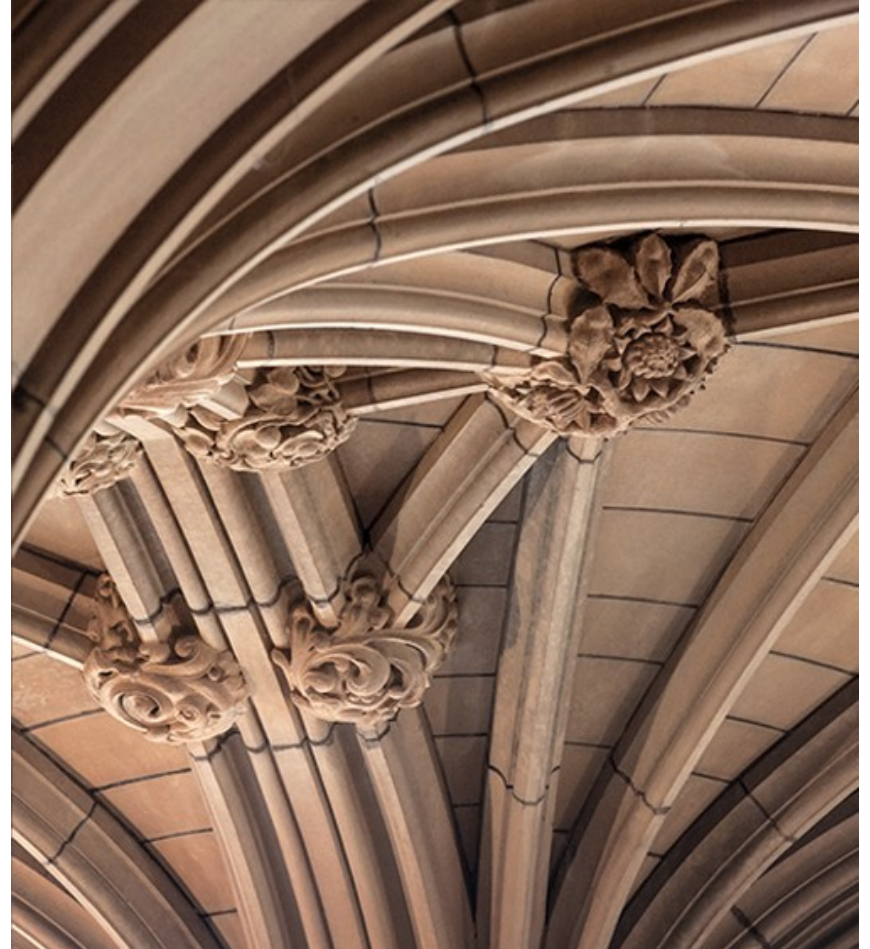
- Respect@Sydney, designed to give you an understanding of consent, boundaries and respectful relationships (*mandatory for commencing students*).
- Academic Honesty Education Module (*mandatory for commencing students*).
- Engaging with Civility, a module where you can unpack the values and expectations outlined in our Student Charter, including information about penalties for breaching our codes of conduct and displaying threatening, discriminatory or racist behaviour.
- Anti-Slavery Awareness Module.

Many of these modules are mandatory for commencing students and your results may be withheld if you do not complete them.

Useful links

- www.sydney.edu.au/students/a-guide-for-new-students.html
- www.sydney.edu.au/students/glossary.html
- www.sydney.edu.au/students/support.html 
- www.sydney.edu.au/students/academic-integrity.html 
- www.sydney.edu.au/students/exams.html
- <https://www.sydney.edu.au/students/scams.html>
- <https://www.library.sydney.edu.au/libraries/library-facilities.html>
- <https://www.sydney.edu.au/students/log-in-to-university-systems.html>
- <https://www.sydney.edu.au/students/student-it.html> 
- <https://www.sydney.edu.au/students/key-dates.html>

Capstone Unit Overview



Capstone Project - Administration

- Unit Coordinator: Dr. Rex di Bona
 - UoS content perspective
- Project Officer/Admin Support: Mrs. Mayondhi Siriwarnasinghe
 - Client/supervisor, project perspective
- Contact Information
 - Teaching Team Email: cs.capstone@sydney.edu.au
 - Please put [PG Capstone] in the subject when contacting staffs via email

Capstone Project

- Carry out defined piece of independent work
- Apply the knowledge of previous units of study
- Produce substantial/innovative work through **independent study**
- document, report and present project work undertaken to engage an academic and/or professional audience
- You are expected to demonstrate your own technical competence

Types of Capstone Project

- Types of projects
 - Software Engineering, Data Science, Computer Science, Cybersecurity, etc
 - **From academia and industry**
- Group work (for 5703)
 - Simulate a real-world situation with different roles in a team
 - Final mark consists of individual mark and group mark
- Individual work (for 5709 and 5707/5708)
 - Undertake a project with supervisor
 - Final mark consists of individual mark only

Capstone Project - Assessment

- Assessment components of the course

Assessment	Weight
Project Proposal	10%
Progress Reports	10%
Presentation / Seminar	15%
Final Report / Deliverables	65%

- All assessment components are mandatory -- **submitted via Canvas**
- Templates for assessments can be found via Canvas as well
 - All templates will be visible to students from week 2

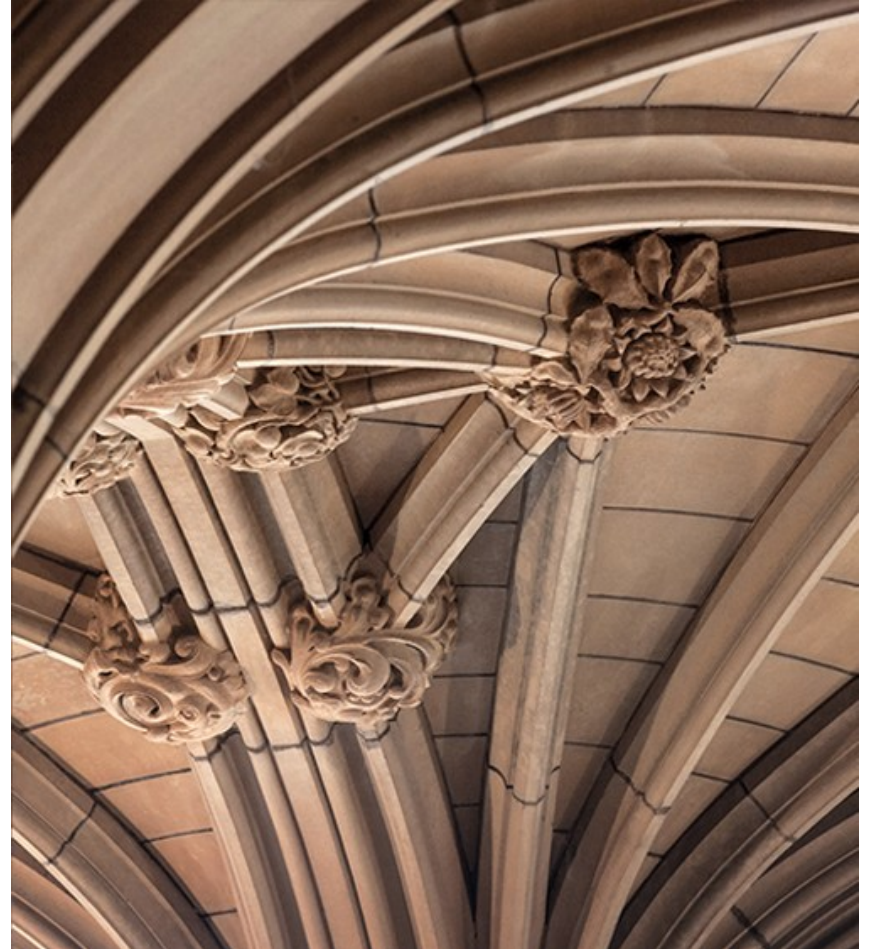
Assessment Plagiarism and Late Submission

- All assessments will be checked via similarity checking tools
 - For all assessments, similarity score **cannot be over 35%**
 - Students are not allowed to copy contents from their previous submitted documents/reports
- Late submission (**penalty applied by Canvas automatically**):
 - Deduction of **5%** of **the maximum mark** for each calendar day after the due date, for example the total mark for assignment 1 is 50 points, you submit it two days late. The original mark can be awarded to you is 43, then the real mark you can get for this assignment after applying the late penalty by Canvas is: $43 - 5\% \times 2 \times 50 = 38$ points
 - After ten calendar days late, a mark of zero will be awarded

Requirement from University

- **All** students who are going to do Capstone projects **MUST** sign a student deed before you officially start your project on WEEK 2
 - Student deed template has been made visible to you on Canvas
 - Sign it as required before you officially start your project on week 2
 - **Witness: anyone who is 18 years or older**
 - Submit it on Canvas as required immediately after you have signed it.
 - Question or concern about the student deed
 - Contact our project officer Mrs. Mayondhi Siriwarnasinghe via

Individual Capstone Unit



Unit Information

- Individual Capstone Unit (5709)
 - WAM is 75 or above
 - Complete project in one semester
- Individual Part-time Capstone Unit (5707 & 5708)
 - For part-time students only
 - Complete project in two semesters

Unit Information

- Students must have a supervisor before enrollment
 - Enrollment procedure could be found on [CS Canvas page](#)
- Regularly meet supervisor for progress check
 - Recommend to start project no later than week 2
 - Recommend one-hour meeting per week with supervisor
 - **No NEED** to attend the tutorial allocated to you on Timetable
- Attention: Project Status Checking Form
 - report project status to supervisor
 - confirm expectation and scope
 - Hurdle task, submitted on Canvas by the end of week 4

Assessments for 5707&5708

First Semester (5707)	Following Semester (5708)
Individual Proposal Report (10%) • Report Week 5 • expected to be approx. 15 pages Individual Progress Report • Report Week 13 (4%) • expected to be approx. 10 pages	Individual Progress Report • Report Week 6 (6%) • expected to be approx. 10 pages Individual Final Report (65%) • Report Week 13 • expected to be approx. 50 pages Individual Presentation (15%) • Formal Exam Week 1

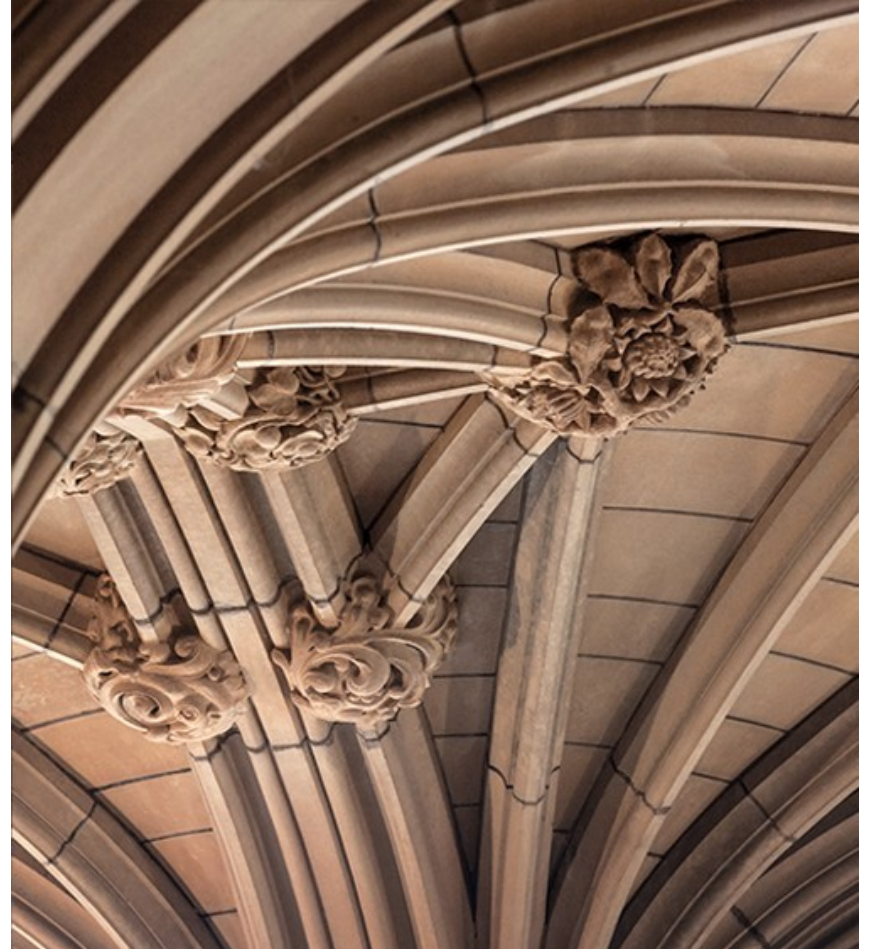
Assessments for 5709

- **Individual Proposal Report (10%)**
 - Report Week 5
 - expected to be approx. 15 pages
- **Individual Progress Report (10%)**
 - Report Week 9
 - expected to be approx. 15 pages
- **Individual Final Report (65%)**
 - Report Week 13
 - expected to be approx. 50 pages (including tables, figures and references, but not appendices)
- **Individual Presentation (15%)**
 - Formal Exam Week 1
 - Arranged by your supervisor by inviting a second marker

Marking Team for Individual Capstone Project Units

- Individual project proposal and project progress reports
 - Marked by the supervisor(s)
- Individual project presentation
 - This will **be organized by your supervisor(s)** rather than the teaching team, including a proper time and venue (in-person or online)
 - A second marker will be invited by your supervisor for marking
- Individual project final report
 - The same second marker who is going to mark your presentation will be invited by your supervisor to mark your final report as well

Group Capstone Unit



Project Selection

- Project preference selection form has been closed
 - TA will contact you if all your preferences have gone or not form a group
- Group sizes will be at 8 students
 - No priority differences on project allocation but group with 7 members might be assigned one more group member who has the same project interest – **find one more NOW**
- Project allocation has started and in progress
 - Allocation result will be displayed to you on **Canvas** by the end of week 1 or earlier
- Start group work in the first tutorial on week 2
 - Tutor info, Client info, Tutorial info will all be released to you on Canvas on week 2 and announcement will be posted to you when info released

Capstone Project - Expectations

- Work closely with your team, tutor and client
- Work required for the Capstone Project
 - At least 18h per week, own time over a period of 12 weeks
 - 1h meeting per week with tutor in tutorials
 - regularly communication with your client
 - Your group **MUST** meet at least once a week **in addition to** tutorial and client meeting time
 - Hand in individual reports about your work as required
 - *Part of your individual mark!*
- Be pro-active:
 - Manage your time well
 - Keep track of the tasks / use a diary
 - Communicate well and frequently with group members

Communication Tools

- **Communication between group members**

- One chat forum Ed Discussions for each project. Each group will have a separate label
- Add tutors and/or client to your project

- For group projects

- Communication via tools is part of you
- Use it and **keep a record of it regular**



Use of Communication Tools



Team communication
platform, used only for
**PROFESSIONAL
communication**

01

02

Post as much as
possible to keep track
of the progress and
get on the same page

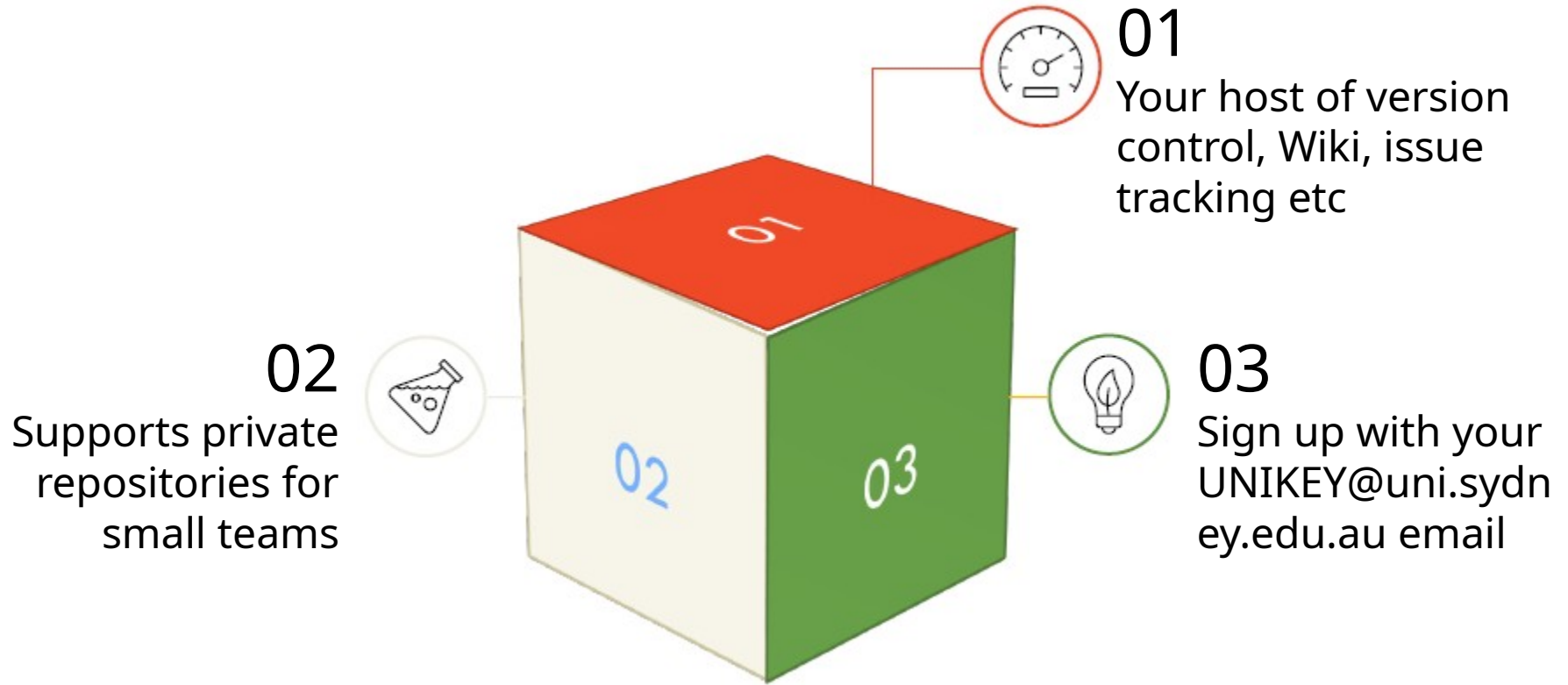


03

Your
communication
will also be
referenced during
the marking

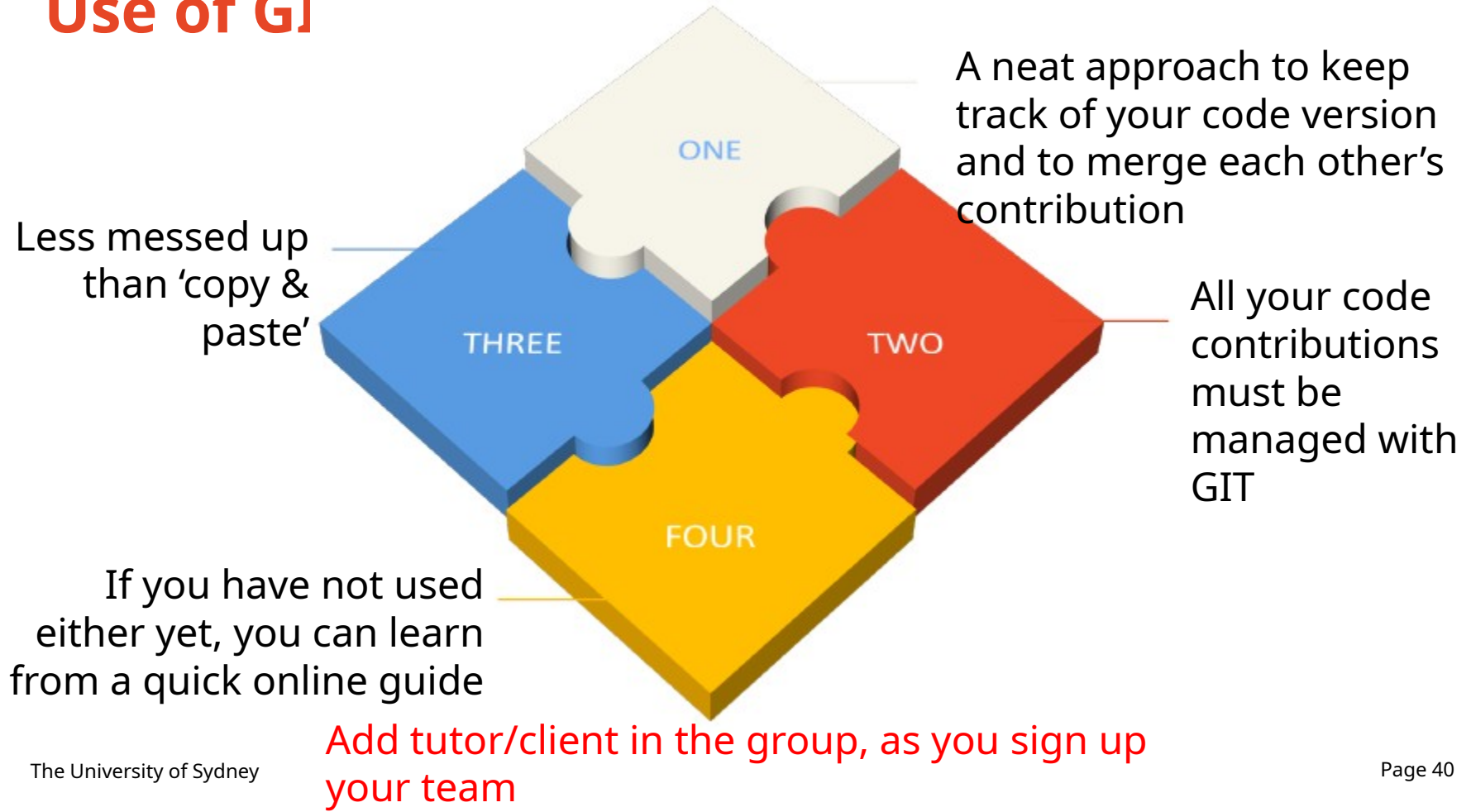


Code on GIT



Add tutor/client in the group, as you sign up
your team

Use of GIT



Important Note about Privacy

- The Repository your group created on GIT MUST be set as **PRIVATE**.
- Due to privacy, you are **NOT allowed** to download/clone any codebase/resource shared by your project client into your own repository or laptop UNLESS you get the approval from your client

Assessment Components for 5703

- Project Proposal, Progress Report and Final Report
 - Group document (submitted per group)
 - Technical document
 - Individual documents (submitted by individuals)
 - What was done by each group member
- Final Presentation is delivered as a group with Q&A session
- For each component
 - **Total Mark = group mark * individual mark**
- The individual mark is used as a scaling factor only!
 - 0% individual Mark => Total Mark is 0%!
 - 100% Individual Mark => Total Mark is Group Mark

Mark Components (5703)

- **Proposal Component**
 - Group Report on Week 5
 - Individual Component Report on Week 6
- **Progress Component**
 - Group Report on Week 9
 - Individual Component Report on Week 9
- **Final Component**
 - Group Report on Week 13
 - Individual Component Report on Week 12
- **Presentation Component**
 - Presentation video on Week 14
 - Live Q&A session on Final Exam week 1

Mark Components (5703)

- **Proposal Component (10%)**
 - $(\text{Individual mark}/100 * \text{group mark}/100) * 10$
- **Progress Component (10%)**
 - $(\text{Individual mark}/100 * \text{group mark}/100) * 10$
- **Final Component (65%)**
 - $(\text{Individual mark}/100 * \text{group mark}/100) * 65$
- **Presentation Component (15%)**
 - $(\text{Group mark}/100) * 15$

Submission of Individual Report

- Hand in an **Individual Report** for each member. What you need to discuss in your individual report, for example:
 - **Your** role in the group project
 - Leader, librarian (minutes/archivist), trouble-shooter
 - Outline **your** personal timelines in doing the tasks allocated to you
 - Describe **your** individual contribution in **technical details**
 - **Evidence** of successful communication on group collaboration in detail
 - Acknowledge and reference **the use of AI**
 - Peer review report that **you** can review the performance of your peers
 - Your view of progress status of your project
 - Your reflections on learning outcomes

Project Proposal (Group Work)

- Important document for organising time and resources to complete the project
- mandatory; uploaded to canvas
- Expect to be at least 15 pages (depending on project)
- Is an informal “Contract” between client and your group
- Is marked based on the quality and structure
- Templates will be provided on Canvas

Progress Report (Group Work)

- Reports on the progress of your project
- mandatory; uploaded to Canvas
- Expected to be at least 15 pages
- Report on progress by listing achievements as outlined by project proposal
- Raise issues that have not been addressed in the project proposal
- Updated timeline to complete the project

Presentation (Group Work)

- Presentation involves a set of slides presenting the project
 - 15min presentation recording + 20min Q&A session
- Mandatory – **fail to attend the presentation means fail the unit**
- Audience
 - Your tutor / client / assessor
- An assessor will assess your presentation
- Upload presentation video and slides to Canvas
- Each group member MUST be familiar with the whole project
- Attention please: your client(s) may provide their feedback to your work, but they will not be involved in the marking process of your presentation

Final Report (Group Work)

- Summarise your findings
- Mandatory, expected to be approx. 50 pages (including tables, figures and references, but not appendices)
- Explain problem, related work / background, your methodology, findings
- An assessor will mark the thesis under the moderation of the teaching team
- Needs to be uploaded to Canvas
- Templates for reports will be found on Canvas

Tutorial Attendance and Presentation

- Tutorial (from week 2 to week 13)
 - On campus attendance is mandatory, penalty applied for absence
 - Each member MUST present their individual progress (5 minutes) from week 3 to week 13 and **properly answer the questions** you receive.
 - Absence with evidenced reasons – join online – **up to 2 chances**
 - Weekly presentation template will be found on Canvas

Client meeting

- Client Meeting (from week 2 to week 13)
 - Client meeting attendance is mandatory
 - For client meeting, a **weekly** meeting minute MUST be conducted in group-based format.
 - It is fine if your group's client meeting might not happen weekly. For such week, just put "no client meeting as agreed" in the meeting minutes template
 - Template for client meeting minutes will be found on Canvas

Project status checking

- Project status checking (week 4, week 8 and week 13)
 - Does not count to the final grade but is a “must” work
 - **Failure to submit this assessment will result in a failure grade for this project unit.**
 - Present an update of your project to your client and seek feedback from the client.
 - Summarise what you have presented and client’s feedback, **together with all client meeting minutes** in a document, sign by both group members and client
 - Detailed instructions will be released on Canvas

Very Important Notes

- Resource Support by Client/Supervisor
 - All resource required by the project will be supported by the project client (group Capstone) or the project supervisor (individual Capstone)
 - No extra funding or project resource (e.g., server) provided from unit of study perspective
 - Standard resource request process:
 - Discuss the resource (**with cost**) that your group need to complete this project **with your client/supervisor** before you use any of these resource.
 - **Get the approval** from your client/supervisor on both the resource and especially the cost
 - Make an **agreement** with your client/supervisor on the cost reimbursement
 - **Well record** all above emails before your group starts to use the resource (with cost)
- **Start to use the approved resource, keep your client/supervisor regularly updated on the cost spent, record all communication emails, and reimburse**

Very Important Notes

- Keep record of group collaboration
 - Communication on tools, meeting minutes, peer review form, etc
 - Inform your tutor immediately if anything goes wrong
 - Complaint with evidence needs to be provided **no later than WEEK 16**
- Overall feedback from client(s)
 - Your client(s) will provide their overall feedback on your work completion and quality to the teaching team at the end of the semester, which will then be considered in the marking process of your final mark

Very Important Notes

- Group formation and project selection
 - Please contact the teaching team immediately via the email address cs.capstone@sydney.edu.au if you have any difficulties in group formation or haven't submitted your project selection
 - Project list has been updated to reflect the available projects
 - We will contact you soon

Thank you

Q&A session